

Patent Assignee-Firm Bridge with Web Search Results

Seula Kim
Pennsylvania State University

Karam Jo
Pennsylvania State University

CES Technical Notes
CES-TN-2026-17

Abstract

In this memo, we construct a patent assignee-firm longitudinal bridge between U.S. patent assignees and firms using firm-level administrative data from the U.S. Census Bureau with web search results. We match granted patents applied between 1976 and 2016 to the U.S. firms recorded in the Longitudinal Business Database (LBD) in the Census Bureau. Building on existing algorithms in the literature, we first use the assignee name, address (state and city), and year information to link the two datasets. We then introduce a novel search-aided algorithm. Overall, we are able to match 88.2

Relevant Datasets: SSEL, LBD, USPTO PatentsView

Required Dataset Permissions: SSEL 1976-2016; LBD 1976-2016

CES Technical Notes may contain confidential data and, thereby, disclosure is prohibited. The opinions, conclusions and suggestions expressed in these notes are those of the authors and do not represent those of the U.S. Census Bureau. Researchers (CES staff, SSS and other Census employees) who wish to access the full text of a technical note or submit their own technical note should contact CES.Technical.Notes.List@census.gov.